

Our Father?

A Collection Of Poems

Kiminou Knox

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How Can You Be My Shepherd When I Keep Walking Off Cliffs?

I've felt Your staff against my skin,
The curved wood promising protection,
Yet here I stand at the precipice again,
Wind howling through the hollow of my chest,
Stones crumbling beneath uncertain feet,
The valley below dark with possibilities,
My shadow stretches toward the fall.

They told me You watch Your flock,
That not one lamb escapes Your gaze,
But my wool is matted with thorns and mud,
And I've wandered paths You never cleared,
Following the scent of something wild,
Something that calls louder than Your voice
Did You let me go, or did I break free?

The earth gives way like promises,
Each step forward a negotiation with gravity,

While You remain somewhere distant,
Perhaps watching, perhaps turned away,
Your eyes on more obedient sheep,
Who don't question the narrowness of Your path,
Who doesn't yearn for what lies beyond the fence.

I've tasted the salt of a thousand tears,
Watched the sun rise on mornings after falling,
My bones broken then mended crooked,
Each scar a map of where You weren't
Or perhaps where You were testing,
The limits of faith against the pull of earth,
The strength of belief against the weight of doubt.

Shepherd, if that's truly what You are,
Why do I keep finding these edges?
These dangerous perimeters of existence
Where the ground no longer holds,
Where Your green pastures give way
To barren rock and empty air
Is this freedom or abandonment?

The wind speaks in tongues I almost understand,
Carrying whispers of other fallen sheep,
Who walked off cliffs with eyes wide open,
Not in despair but in terrible curiosity,
Wondering if You would catch them,
Or if the falling itself might be
The answer they'd been seeking all along.

If You are my Shepherd,

why does the void mouth my name

like an old hymn?

Why do my feet ache for the cliff's edge

when a whisper could have held me still?

Did You carve this hunger into my bones,

or did I teach myself to starve

Why Can't I Hear You When I Need You Most?

In the dark cathedral of midnight panic,
When my lungs forget their holy purpose,
And my heart drums against my chest
Like it's trying to break free from prison,
I call Your name into the void,
But my voice echoes back alone,
A mockery of prayer, hollow and unanswered.

I've pressed my ear to the ground,
Listening for Your footsteps approaching.
I've climbed to mountain peaks,
Where they say heaven touches earth.
I've knelt until my knees bled devotion,
Yet Your voice remains a memory,
Or worse a story someone else told me.

The prophets claim You spoke in fire,
In whirlwinds, in the splitting of seas,
That You thundered commandments from clouds,
That You whispered in still, small voices.
But where is that voice when darkness swallows me?

When grief carves canyons through my chest?

When doubt becomes my only companion?

They say You're a father who gives good gifts,

But what child cries out without response?

What parent stands silent behind a locked door

While their child screams with nightmares?

Is this some divine test of endurance?

Or have You simply turned Your face away,

Attending prayers more worthy than mine?

I built altars from the ruins of my expectations,

Sacrificing certainty on faith's pyre

Burning every bridge to comfort,

Just to hear one syllable from You.

Yet the heavens stay sealed,

A bronze sky reflecting only my own face,

While my questions circle like starving birds.

The silence between stars stretches vast,

The space between prayer and answer wider still,

And I wonder if You're testing the tensile strength
Of a faith pulled taut to breaking point,
Or if this is just how god's love from distance,
Watching us struggle to interpret silence,
Finding meaning in cosmic indifference.

When I needed You most, where were Your words?
When my world collapsed into ash and bone,
When betrayal made a home in my heart,
When loneliness became my only language
Was Your silence meant to teach or punish?
Or is the terrible truth much simpler:
You were speaking, but not to me?

Why Does It Feel Like I'm Talking to Myself?

My prayers rise like smoke from a dying fire,
Curling toward a ceiling of indifference,
Dissipating before they reach Your ears
If You have ears at all, if You're there at all.
Each word feels heavier than the last,

Dragged from the depths of dwindling hope,
Landing with a thud at my own feet.

I've crafted beautiful cathedrals of language,
Soaring arches of praise and supplication,
Stained glass windows of confession,
Intricate mosaics of gratitude and need.
Yet when I step back to marvel at my creation,
I find myself alone in the sanctuary,
The only witness to my own devotion.

They say prayer changes things
But what if the only change is in me?
What if I'm reshaping myself around the silence,
Learning to mistake echo for answer,
Interpreting coincidence as intervention,
Finding patterns in randomness,
Convincing myself I'm not alone in this room?

The walls of my skull enclose these thoughts,
Bouncing back every question I hurl at You,

Until I can no longer distinguish
Between Your voice and my own conscience,
Between divine wisdom and human rationalization,
Between heavenly comfort and self soothing lies
Have I created You in my image instead?

My knees bear the marks of devotion,
My throat raw from whispered pleas,
My journal filled with one sided conversations,
Yet I cannot shake this growing suspicion
That prayer is simply the mind talking to itself,
The heart comforting its own wounds,
The soul pretending it's not ultimately alone.

Sometimes in the depths of night,
When even the stars seem to have turned away,
I catch myself listening for a response
That part of me knows it will never come.
Is faith just the stubborn refusal to accept
That the universe isn't listening, doesn't care,
That we're shouting into our own cupped hands?

Still I speak Your name into the darkness,
Still I pour out my heart like water,
Still I wait for the moment when the monologue
Might suddenly become a conversation.
But until then, I wonder with each prayer:
Am I communing with the divine,
Or just getting better at talking to myself?

If You Hold My Future, Why Can't You Show Me A Glimpse?

The road ahead disappears into fog,
Each step a negotiation with the unseen,
While You supposedly stand at the end,
Holding a map I'm not allowed to read.

I move forward on trembling legs,
Faith a blindfold I'm told to wear proudly,
Uncertainty disguised as spiritual virtue.

They say You've counted every hair on my head,
That You knew me before I was formed,

That my days were written in Your book
Before one of them came to be.

If so, then why this cruel suspense?
This cosmic game of blindman's bluff,
Where do I grope forward while You watch?

I've seen fortune tellers with crystal balls,
Weather forecasters with satellite views,
Doctors with machines that peer inside the body,
Scientists who predict the paths of stars

Yet the God who shaped the cosmos
Can't spare a flashlight beam of foresight
For a child lost in the woods of indecision?

Is it kindness that keeps You silent,
Some divine wisdom that knows
I couldn't bear the weight of foreknowledge?
Or do You enjoy the spectacle of our stumbling,
Our desperate attempts to discern Your will

From tea leaves, coincidences, and the wind,
Our meaning making from meaningless signs?

The prophets claimed to see what's coming,
Spoke of lions lying with lambs,
Of swords beaten into plowshares,
Of tears wiped away forever.

But what about my small, mortal future?
The choices that keep me awake at night?
The crossroads where I stand paralyzed?

I'm not asking for the full revelation,
Just a glimpse to know I'm not lost,
A whispered hint of what awaits,
A shadow of purpose cast on my path.

Instead, You offer parables about birds,
About lilies that neither toil nor spin,
About treasures in heaven I cannot see.

If my future rests secure in Your hands,
If every step is divinely orchestrated,

Then why does each choice feel like a gamble?

Why does regret follow me like a shadow?

Why does anxiety gnaw at the edges of faith,

Unless the terrible truth is simpler than they say:

You know as little about tomorrow as I do?

Did You Make Me Too Weak To Follow You?

My spirit willing but this flesh so frail,

Bones like brittle branches in winter,

Heart a wild creature I cannot tame,

Mind a labyrinth I get lost within.

Did You fashion me from inferior clay?

Mix too much dust with too little breath?

Make me a vessel certain to crack?

I watch others walk Your path with ease,

Their faith seemingly untroubled by doubt,

Their morality uncomplicated by desire,

Their service is untainted by selfish motives.

Did You give them stronger materials?

Better instructions? Clearer vision?

Or am I looking at masks, not faces?

The weight of Your commandments

Presses down like stones on my chest.

I try to lift them, to carry them forward,

But my arms shake, my back bends,

My knees buckle under the holy burden.

Did You design me to fail these tests?

Create me too weak to earn Your love?

I've fallen so many times I've lost count,

Each resolution shattered by sunrise,

Each promise broken before the day ends,

Each attempt at righteousness stained.

Is this the destiny You wrote for me?

This constant cycle of try and fail,

Of reach and fall, of hope and despair?

The saints speak of transformation,
Of putting off the old self like a garment,
Of being renewed, remade, reborn.

But what if my fabric is inherently flawed?
What if the pattern You cut me from
Was destined for beauty but marked for breaking,
For falling short of glory by design?

You ask me to be perfect as You are perfect,
To be holy as You are holy,
To love as You have loved.

But You made me limited, finite, human
With eyes that cannot see past horizons,
A heart that bleeds when barely scratched,
And a will that bends like grass in the wind.

Did You create me too weak to follow,
Or is my weakness itself the path?
Is it in breaking that I become whole?

In falling I learn to rise?

In failing that I find Your grace?

Or is that just another story I tell myself

To make sense of a design beyond understanding?

If You're The Answer, Why Do I Have So Many Questions?

They hand me Your name like a skeleton key,

Promising it will unlock every door,

Solve every puzzle, heal every wound,

End every argument, calm every fear.

"God is the answer," they say with certainty,

As if Your name is the period

At the end of a perfect sentence.

But each answer You provide

Spawns a hundred new questions,

Each revelation casts shadows

I hadn't noticed before.

Each scripture opens trapdoors
Beneath what I thought was solid ground
If You're the answer,
Why am I drowning in questions?

The more I learn of Your ways,
The less I understand Your nature.
You command love but permit suffering,
Demand justice but extend mercy,
Create beauty but allow destruction,
Promise presence but feel absent,
Reveal truth wrapped in riddles.

Each prayer answered leaves me wondering
About a thousand prayers were ignored.
Each miracle witnessed makes me question
Why does such power stay so hidden?
Each glimpse of Your goodness forces me to ask
About evil that thrives unchecked
Are You the answer, or the greatest question of all?

The faithful tell me to stop asking,
To accept mystery as a gift,
To embrace paradox as divine,
To see questions as a lack of faith.

But if You made me in Your image,
Didn't You include this restless mind,
This hunger to understand what lies beyond?

Scientists dissect the cosmos,
Philosophers probe existence,
Artists capture glimpses of transcendence,
All seeking answers to ancient questions.

Did You plant this curiosity in our souls,
Then command us not to use it?
Create a lock but forbid the key?

If You truly are the answer,
The omega to every alpha,
The destination of every journey,
The fulfillment of every longing

Then why does finding You

Only multiply my questions?

Why does Your light reveal more darkness?

Are You Lost Too?

Sometimes I wonder, in the quietest moments,

When the world sleeps and doubts awaken,

If You're searching for something too.

If beyond the throne and the glory

And the angels' songs,

There's a restlessness in Your infinity,

A question mark in Your omniscience,

A loneliness even creation couldn't fill.

What if Your silence isn't strategic or punitive,

But the sound of Your own uncertain breathing?

What if Your hiddenness isn't a test of our faith,

But evidence of Your own cosmic wandering?

What if the distance we feel isn't discipline,
But the space You need to figure things out,
To come to terms with what You've made?

They say You never change, never waver,
That Your course was set before time began,
That every sparrow's fall is choreographed,
Every galaxy's spiral is predetermined.

But what a terrible burden that would be
To never discover, never wonder, never grow,
To have all answers but ask no questions.

If You're lost too, somehow,
In the infinite possibilities of existence,
In the labyrinth of free will You bestowed,
In the mystery of love that even God must learn,

Then perhaps our wandering isn't failure.
Perhaps it's inheritance, perhaps it's design,
Perhaps it's how we're most like You.

Why Does Every Blessing Feel Like A Curse?

You give me love wrapped in barbed wire,
Joy that bleeds at its edges,
Honey with a bitter aftertaste.

Every gift You place in my hands
Carries the weight of what it will cost me.

The child You blessed me with
Taught me to fear death in new ways.
The success You granted
Revealed the hollow in my chest
Where contentment should have lived.

You offer water to the thirsty
Then drown them in the flood.
You provide shelter from the storm
Then tear the roof away
Just as thunder cracks the sky.

Is this Your divine comedy
To watch us clutch Your blessings
Only to discover they're disguised afflictions?
Your gifts arrive as Trojan horses,
Beautiful shells concealing their true nature.

What kind of love gives with one hand
While the other prepares to take?
What lesson hides in this twisted symmetry
Where every height reached
Promises a greater fall to come?

I hold Your blessings like fragile birds,
Afraid to love them fully,
Knowing how Your generosity works
That everything given contains its opposite,
A curse waiting to be revealed.

Who taught You this terrible mathematics
Where joy plus time always equals loss?
Did You design us to never rest in goodness,

To always search the horizon for the coming storm,
Even as we stand in the warm light of Your grace?

How Much Pain Is Enough?

I've swallowed oceans of suffering,
Felt my bones crack under the weight of Your lessons,
Watched my skin grow thick with scars
Your fingerprints left where You've touched me.

How much more must I endure
Before You're satisfied?

You speak of refinement by fire,
But the flames have consumed me entirely.
What remains to be purified
When I am nothing but ash
Scattered across the wasteland of my faith?

Is there a ledger where You mark my pain,
A cosmic threshold I must reach
Before You finally say, "*Enough*"?

Or is suffering itself the point
The endless circle You've designed for me?

They say gold is tested in fire,
But gold doesn't feel the burning.
I am not metal but flesh and spirit,
Crying out beneath Your hammer,
Begging for the shaping to cease.

I've seen children broken beyond repair,
Saints who died questioning Your name,
Faithful servants consumed by doubt.
Does their agony satisfy Your appetite,
Or do You still hunger for more?

Each time I think I've reached the limit,
The ground beneath me gives way
To deeper chambers of suffering.
Is this Your idea of growth
This endless descent into pain?

When will You look upon what remains of me

And declare the work complete?

Or is completion itself a myth,

Another cruel promise to keep us hoping

As the suffering stretches into eternity?

Why Did You Give Me Dreams If You Planned To Crush Them?

You planted seeds of vision in my heart,

Whispered possibilities in my eager ears,

Showed me glimpses of what could be.

Then I watched You systematically destroy

Each tender shoot that dared emerge.

Was this always Your intention

To make me architect of castles in the air,

Only to position me here on solid ground

Where I can watch them collapse,

Too distant to save, too close to ignore?

I followed stars You hung specifically for me,
Trusted the map You placed in my hands,
Only to find myself in unmarked wilderness,
The path behind me erased,
The stars suddenly extinguished.

What divine purpose exists
In this elaborate game of creation and destruction?
Do You delight in watching hope bloom
Only to witness the precise moment
When it withers under reality's harsh sun?

I've buried so many dreams now
I could start a cemetery.
Each grave marked with Your name and mine
Cocreators of visions
Neither of us intended to preserve.

My hands, once open to receive Your promises,
Now curl into fists against my chest,
Protecting what little remains.

Is this what You wanted all along
To teach me to stop dreaming entirely?
Or perhaps this is Your twisted kindness
Showing me that dreams themselves are the problem,
That wanting is the true sin,
That the only safe path through Your world
Is to desire nothing at all.

Why Do You Break What You Claim To Love?

Your love is a hurricane that claims to shelter me
While tearing my foundations apart.
You call Yourself Father while orphaning my hopes,
Healer while inflicting fresh wounds,
Savior while watching me drown.

I've studied the mathematics of Your affection
How it multiplies my pain under the guise of growth,
Divides me from myself in the name of wholeness,
Subtracts my joy while promising abundance,

Adds burden after burden while whispering,

"My yoke is easy."

The potter shouldn't resent the clay for breaking

When it's the potter's hands that apply the pressure.

You shape me with force that cracks my essence,

Then seem surprised when I cannot hold water,

When I leak from the places You've damaged.

Is this love this constant reconstruction?

This endless cycle of breaking and remaking,

As if I am never quite right,

Never finished enough to deserve gentleness,

Never whole enough to escape Your improving touch?

The mother eagle pushes her young from the nest, they say,

But she doesn't break their wings first.

The shepherd leaves ninety-nine to find one,

But doesn't drive the sheep away himself.

What kind of love deliberately wounds what it cherishes?

I wonder sometimes if You understand love at all,
Or if Your divine perspective has forgotten
How fragile human hearts can be,
How we crack under the weight of Your attention,
How Your loving touch leaves bruises we carry for years.

Do You break us because You love us,
Or do You love us because we break?
Is our fragility what attracts Your gaze,
Our tendency to shatter what draws Your hand,
Is our brokenness the only thing You truly cherish?

Am I Being Refined Or Am I Being Destroyed?

The line between purification and annihilation
Grows thinner with each passing day.
I feel myself dissolving in the acid bath of Your lessons,
Watching pieces of who I was float away,
Wondering if anything will remain when You're finished.

The blacksmith knows precisely how much heat
The metal can withstand before it's ruined.

Do You possess such knowledge about my soul,
Or are You experimenting as You go,
Curious to see my breaking point?

I was told this pain would refine me,
That suffering would burn away impurities,
Leaving something precious behind.
But what if there's nothing left but the burning?
What if I am fuel, not gold?

Those who speak of spiritual refinement
Have never felt their very self being consumed.
They imagine gentle remodeling,
Not this violent unmaking
That leaves me unrecognizable even to myself.

Friends tell me to trust the process,
To surrender to Your divine metallurgy.
But they cannot see inside the furnace,
Cannot feel the core of me melting away,
Cannot tell if this is transformation or obliteration.

Sometimes in the depths of night,
I sense You watching the flames,
Your face is illuminated by my burning.
Are You the master craftsman at work,
Or a child fascinated by destruction?

I want to believe this crucible has purpose,
That something valuable will emerge from this agony.
But the question haunts me as I dissolve:
Am I being refined into something better,
Or simply destroyed for Your mysterious pleasure?

If Suffering Brings Me Closer To You, Why Do I Want To Run?

They told me pain would draw me to Your arms,
That suffering would be the bridge between us.
Yet with each fresh wound You allow,
My instinct is not to draw near but to flee,
To hide from the God who permits such torment.

If trials are meant to be the thread
That binds my heart more tightly to Yours,
Why does every affliction feel like scissors,
Cutting whatever connection remained,
Leaving me more isolated than before?

The preacher speaks of breaking horses,
How struggle leads to submission.
Is that Your model of divine love
That I must be broken to be Yours,
That rebellion must be crushed before intimacy can begin?

I've sat in churches where they celebrate suffering,
Praising the God who tests His children.
But their voices sound like hostages,
Convincing themselves their captor loves them,
Finding meaning in chains to avoid confronting their bondage.

If pain is Your love language,
We are speaking past each other.
For when I hurt, I don't see Your face more clearly

It becomes obscured, distant, foreign,
A blurry portrait I struggle to recognize.

Perhaps the greatest mystery of faith
Is this perverse expectation
That we should run toward what harms us,
That we should thank the hand that strikes us,
That agony should produce not flight but devotion.

Suffering doesn't bring me closer;
It builds walls of confusion and doubt.
If this is Your divine strategy for intimacy,
You've misunderstood something fundamental
About the hearts You claim to have created.

Do You Hurt When We Hurt?

When the child screams beneath collapsed rubble,
When the mother cradles her starving infant,
When the innocent hang from crosses of injustice
Does Your divine heart constrict with pain,
Or do You observe with the detachment of eternity?

They say You wept at Lazarus' tomb,
That human suffering moved You to tears.
But what good are divine tears
That fall but nothing?
What use is cosmic empathy without intervention?

If You truly felt the agony of Your creation,
Wouldn't this world be different?
Wouldn't Your love compel You to act,
To end the suffering You allegedly feel,
To finally become the God we need?

Do You compartmentalize our pain,
File it away as necessary for some greater good?
Or does it pierce Your essence,
Make You question Your own methods,
Wonder if the cost of free will is too high?

I need to know that somewhere in the universe,
Someone carries this burden with me.
That when my heart shatters in my chest,

Something in You breaks as well,
That I am not alone in this ocean of suffering.

The God who hurts when we hurt
Would be a God I could follow.
The God who remains unmoved by our agony
Is not a God worth worshipping,
Just a distant tyrant with a cosmic plan.

So tell me, Creator of all that is:
When Your children suffer beneath Your watchful eye,
When we cry out for relief that never comes,
When we break under burdens we cannot carry
Do You hurt too, or are You simply watching the show?

Did You Ever Speak to the Gods We Deny?

Before we carved Your name in stone,
When other deities walked the earth
Did You exchange words with Osiris?
Share wisdom with Vishnu?
Argue with Zeus over territory and tribute?

I wonder about the celestial conversations
That must have echoed across the cosmos,
Divine voices debating which humans to claim,
Which lands to mark as sacred,
Which prophets to whisper mysteries to.

Did You send messengers to Their temples,
Ambassadors to negotiate divine boundaries?
Or did You simply declare Them fiction,
Phantoms invented by misguided minds,
While claiming exclusive rights to truth?

The ancients heard Their voices as clearly as we hear Yours.
They built civilizations on Their commands,
Recorded miracles that matched Your own,
Received revelations that contradicted Yours,
Died believing They were just as real as You.

When the Indigenous elder prays to Grandfather Sky,
When the Hindu prostrates before Shiva,
When the ancient Greek poured libations to Athena

Did You lean close to listen?

Or did You turn away, jealous and dismissive?

Perhaps the great cosmic secret

Is that You've been speaking to each other all along,

Planning which peoples to guide,

Which truths to reveal gradually,

Which aspects of divinity each culture could bear.

Or is loneliness the true burden of godhood

That You are indeed the only voice in the void,

Watching Your creation fragment Your image

Into a thousand divine reflections,

Each one catching just a sliver of Your true face?

Are You the Same God in Every Religion, or Are They

Talking to Someone Else?

Muslims bow toward Mecca five times daily,

Jews wrap themselves in ancient prayers,

Hindus immerse in sacred rivers,

Christians consume their God in bread and wine,
Indigenous peoples dance to honor ancestral spirits.

Are they all reaching toward You
Through different doors in the same house?
Or are some knocking on empty rooms,
Calling names that echo unanswered,
Praying to the cosmic equivalent of wrong numbers?

How terrifying to consider
That some faiths might have the right address
While others send their devotions
Into an unresponsive void,
Their spiritual GPS fatally miscalibrated.

More terrifying still:
What if they're all connecting to something real,
But not all to You?
What if the universe holds multiple divine consciousnesses,
Each one claiming exclusive truth?

The woman bowing before Kali,
 The man communing with Allah,
 The child saying bedtime prayers to Jesus
 Are they speaking different languages to the same ear,
 Or addressing entirely different beings across the cosmos?

Prophets across time have claimed direct connection,
 Each returning with contradictory revelations.
 Were some of them speaking to imposters?
 Cosmic pretenders wearing divine masks?
 Or fragments of Yourself in different guises?

The answer reshapes everything
 Whether we're all climbing the same mountain on different paths,
 Or whether some of us are scaling entirely different peaks,
 Some leading to You, others to alternative divinities,
 And some, perhaps, to nothing at all.

Why Did You Let Other Beliefs Thrive If They Were Lies?

If Yours is the only true voice,
 Why allow the cacophony of competing faiths?

Each one certain of its exclusive truth,
Each one claiming divine authority,
Each one ready to die for its particular god.

A loving father would not let his children
Follow strangers promising candy.
A truthful teacher would correct
Students repeating dangerous falsehoods.
Yet You've watched billions worship "false" gods for millennia.

Hinduism flourished for thousands of years
Before Your Bible was assembled.
Buddhism spread its compassionate message
While Your prophets spoke of vengeance.
Were these merely elaborate divine tests?

If salvation depends on correct belief,
Your communication strategy seems deliberately cruel
To birth souls into cultures with established faiths,
Then condemn them for following
The only spiritual path they've ever known.

Some say You plant truth in every tradition,
That all religions contain partial revelations.
But this contradicts Your demands for exclusive worship,
Your commandments against other gods,
Your promises that there is only one narrow path.

The simplest explanation is the most disturbing:
Either You don't care what we believe,
Or You're not the only voice speaking,
Or perhaps most terrifying of all
You're testing which humans can discern true divinity from false.

What kind of God allows billions of souls
To live and die in sincere devotion to the "wrong" faith?
One whose plans transcend our understanding,
One who values free will above correct belief,
Or one who isn't what any religion claims Him to be?

If The Truth Is One, Why Did You Let It Be Splintered?

You spoke Your truth, we're told,
In clear, unambiguous terms.

Yet that singular revelation
Fractured like light through a prism
Into countless contradicting interpretations.

Catholics and Protestants killed each other
Over the meaning of Your words.
Sunni and Shia spill blood to this day,
Each claiming authentic understanding.
Different Buddhists follow divergent paths to enlightenment.

If Your message was crystal clear,
Why has it generated endless division?
Did You deliberately speak in riddles
To watch us struggle with meaning,
To test which humans could discern Your true intent?

Christians alone have splintered into thousands of denominations,
Each claiming the proper reading of the same text.
Same book, same God, wildly different conclusions
All convinced they alone have correctly
Decoded the divine communiqué.

The truth should unite, not divide.

Clarity should bring consensus, not conflict.

Your fractured revelation has caused more bloodshed

Then perhaps any other force in human history.

Was this Your plan all along?

Perhaps You never intended a single truth at all,

But scattered different facets of wisdom

Across diverse cultures and ages,

Like a cosmic scavenger hunt

Requiring all of humanity to complete the puzzle.

Or perhaps the splintering itself

Is proof that no single voice spoke,

That humans have been projecting

Their own values, fears, and hopes

Onto the silent canvas of an uncommunicative cosmos.

Is the Devil Just a God Who Lost?

History is written by the victors, they say.

Does this apply to divine history as well?

Is Satan simply a deity who lost the cosmic war,
His worship criminalized,
His story rewritten by the conquering God?

Every villain was once someone's hero.
Every demon was once someone's god.
The horned deities of ancient faiths
Became the devils of newer religions
Divine rebranding after a celestial coup.

The serpent in Eden offered knowledge,
The morning star brought illumination,
The adversary demanded justice
When Job was cruelly tested.
Are these the actions of evil,
Or of a different kind of good?

How convenient for a jealous God
To paint all competing deities as demons,
To reframe divine rivalry as cosmic evil,

To cast the other gods in the role of adversary,
Converting religious pluralism into spiritual warfare.

Perhaps Lucifer was the first heretic,
The first to question divine authority,
The first to suggest alternative interpretations,
The first to wonder if the ruling God
Was indeed as benevolent as claimed.

In ancient pantheons, gods competed openly,
Each with their domains and followers.
Only monotheism needed devils
Theological repositories for the gods they displaced,
Supernatural villains to explain competing divine voices.

I wonder if, in some parallel reality,
The cosmic battle ended differently,
And what we call the Devil sits on heaven's throne,
While today's God is taught as the great deceiver,
The definitions of good and evil are perfectly reversed.

Are There Others Like You?

Does the universe host a pantheon of beings

Similar to Yourself but distinct

Cosmic entities watching different galaxies,

Divine consciousnesses evolving along separate paths,

Creator gods with their own realms and rules?

Are You truly alone in Your godhood,

A solitary being without peer or companion?

Or do You belong to some celestial community,

A society of similar beings

Who shares the burden of existence?

The concept of divine loneliness is staggering

To be the only consciousness of Your kind,

With no equal to challenge or understand You,

No peer to share eternity with,

No companion who knows the weight of creating worlds.

Perhaps this explains Your obsession with humanity

Not that we're so extraordinary,

But that we're the closest thing You have to company,

Pale reflections of Yourself,

Better than the crushing solitude of absolute uniqueness.

Or maybe the cosmos teems with godlike beings

Just beyond our perception,

Each tending their own universal gardens,

Occasionally crossing paths at the edges of creation,

Sharing notes on the curious experiment of conscious life.

Do You envy them their domains,

Compete with them for cosmic resources,

Learn from their alternate methods,

Compare the faithful of Your realm to theirs,

Take pride in the particular devotion of Your creation?

The vastness of existence suggests

That anything possible exists somewhere.

If God is possible, then surely many gods are equally so

Unless the nature of divinity itself

Requires absolute singularity in an otherwise infinite universe.

If We Called You By Another Name, Would You Still

Answer?

If I called You Allah, would You turn Your ear?

If I addressed You as Brahma, would You recognize Yourself?

If I prayed to the Great Spirit, would You accept the invitation?

Or are You bound strictly to the particular syllables

Recorded in one tradition's holy book?

A rose by any other name, they say

But does divinity follow the same rule?

Are You the substance behind all sacred names,

Or are You particular in Your identity,

Responding only to certain holy words?

Some believers insist the divine name has power,

That certain syllables unlock cosmic forces,

That precision in spiritual language is essential.

But this implies a God extraordinarily small

One trapped by human phonetics and semantics.

A mother answers to "Mom," "Mama," "Mother,"

Recognizing the intent behind various forms of address.

Would the Creator of language itself be less flexible?

More concerned with terminology than with the heart

Of the one reaching out across the divine human divide?

I have heard prayers in a hundred languages,

Witnessed devotion to differently named divinities,

Observed sincerity that transcends terminology.

Does the cosmic switchboard sort these calls by name,

Routing them to different divine recipients?

Perhaps the greatest test of faith is this:

To believe that divine love transcends nomenclature,

That the God of a thousand names recognizes them all,

That the heart's intention outweighs the tongue's precision,

That no sincere prayer is ever misdirected.

Or perhaps the ultimate truth is more disturbing still:

That You answer to one name in exclusivity,

That billions pray sincerely but to the wrong address,

That divine connection depends on correct terminology,
That salvation hangs on a phonetic lottery we never chose to enter.

Why Do I Keep Failing You?

Did You Make Me a Sinner Just to Watch Me Fall?

My son feels embedded in my marrow,
A birthright I never asked to inherit.
Was I designed with this fatal flaw,
This crack that runs from crown to sole?

Sometimes I wonder if my bent toward breaking
Is not a glitch but a feature of Your design
A cosmic experiment in predestined failure.

You sculpted me from dust and dreams,
Breathed life into clay that now crumbles daily.

Did Your fingers tremble as they shaped me,
Knowingly planting the seeds of my undoing?

Or did You smile at the perfect imperfection,
At ribs too weak to cage the wild heart,
At a mind wired to want what destroys it?

The first sin echoes through my veins
Like a song I've known since before language.
I feel the fruit's sweetness on my tongue
Though I've never walked in Eden's shade.

Did You place the tree there expecting the worst,
Or does omniscience mean You always knew
I would be born already fallen, already lost?

I imagine You watching from beyond the stars,
Tracking each stumble, each shameful night,
Each moment I choose shadow over light.

Are these my failures or Your successes?
Is my struggle the very theater You created,

A stage where my weakness serves as entertainment

For eyes that never close, never look away?

The pattern feels too perfect to be chance

This endless cycle of sin, shame, redemption, repeat.

Did You make salvation so sweet

Because You knew the fall would be inevitable?

Is grace merely the counterweight to a burden

You intentionally made it too heavy to bear?

What kind of love designs its beloved to break?

Sometimes in darkness I hear laughter

And cannot tell if it's Yours or the serpent's.

Am I the punchline in some divine comedy,

The clay pot formed specifically to shatter?

If You are perfect, why make me so flawed?

If You are in love, why seed me with self destruction?

If You are Father, why set Your child up to fall?

Yet here I stand in my beautiful brokenness,
Wondering if my cracks are not failures
But windows through which Your light was meant to shine.

Perhaps my sin was never the point at all,
But rather what You would do with it
How grace appears most radiant
Against the darkest backdrop of human failing.

Why Does Trying to Be Good Feel Impossible?

I wake with resolute heart, steelspined intentions,
Promises fresh as morning dew on my lips.
By noon they've evaporated in the heat of living,
My will bent back toward familiar sins
Like a compass needle drawn inescapably north.

Who designed this broken moral compass?

Was it You, or is this corruption all my own?

The good I want to do hangs just beyond reach,
A fruit on a branch that bends away from my fingers.

I strain toward virtue, muscles trembling with effort,
Yet find myself empty handed by day's end,
Cradling only the weight of what I failed to become.

Why does evil come as natural as breathing
While goodness requires the struggle of drowning?

I've crafted a thousand paper boats of intention,
Set them sailing on waters of determination,
Only to watch them dissolve in the current,
Their fragile hulls are no match for desire's undertow.

Did You make the pull of wrong so strong
To test the strength of my feeble righteousness,
Or to prove I cannot stand without Your grace?

Your commandments clean, precise as mathematics
Somehow blur when applied to flesh and blood.
I know the formula but fail the solution;
My soul is an equation that never balances.

Why build a house that cannot stand,
Plant a garden destined to wither,
Create a heart that resists its own salvation?

The weight of trying crushes more than failing.
It's not the sin that breaks me but the trying
The endless reaching for a bar set at heaven's height
While my feet remain planted in earthly soil.

Did You intend this cosmic frustration,
This perpetual striving with no arrival,
This race where the finish line recedes with every step?

Sometimes I glimpse it the person I should be
Standing just ahead on the path, waiting,
Face turned away but posture unmistakable:
Shoulders straight with integrity's confidence,
Hands open in genuine generosity,
Steps aligned with justice and mercy.

Why can I see but never become this self?

Perhaps the impossibility is the point

The space between who I am and who I should be

Is where You've always intended to dwell.

Maybe goodness was never meant to be achieved

But eternally pursued, like stars that guide sailors

Without ever being destinations themselves.

Is the beautiful agony of trying Your real gift?

Why Do I Keep Repeating My Mistakes?

The familiar cliff edge I know its contours

By heart now, the exact moment earth gives way

To empty air.

Yet here I stand again, toes curled over the precipice,

Staring down at the same abyss that has claimed me before.

Why does my mind rediscover old dangers

With the enthusiasm of new love?

I've mapped every quicksand pit of my weakness,
Created detailed warnings in my memory:
"Here be dragons," written in scar tissue.

Still, my feet find these paths in darkness,
Unerring as water flowing downhill.
Is this Your grand cosmic joke
To remember everything but wisdom?

The taste of regret is so familiar now
It feels like home cooking, bitter comfort.
I know its flavor before I've even lifted the spoon,
Can anticipate the exact moment of disgust
That follows indulgence like night follows day.

Yet knowledge doesn't disrupt the cycle
Is this the curse of being both god and animal?

Sometimes I catch myself mid fall,
Watching my hands reach for what will burn them,
As if my body belongs to another master.

I hear my voice making the same excuses,
See my heart opening the same rusted doors.
Did You plant this glitch in human programming
This compulsion to circle back to our worst selves?

My mistakes wear grooves in my life
Like water carving canyons through stone
Patient, persistent, deepening with each pass
Until the path of least resistance
Is the very one that leads to destruction.

What divine purpose is served by this repetition?
What lesson am I missing in the thousandth fall?

The faces change but the script remains
The same words, different mouths;
The same wounds, different weapons;
The same sin, different circumstances.

I am trapped in this recursive nightmare,
A spiritual *Groundhog Day* of failure.
Did You design this loop as punishment or education?

Perhaps the spiral isn't truly a circle
Each iteration slightly higher than the last,
Each failure containing seeds of future victory,
Each repetition teaching me something new
About the bottomless depths of Your grace.

Maybe my mistake is seeing only the pattern
And missing how the fabric slowly transforms.

Does My Guilt Please You?

I've turned shame into an art form,
Sculpted it into cathedrals of self loathing
Where I worship daily at the altar of my failures.
My prayers smell of smoke and remorse,
Each word is an ash covered offering.

Does this please You this ritual flagellation,
This endless catalogue of my insufficiency?
I wear my guilt like a hair shirt,
The constant chafing a reminder
Of every promise broken, every standard failed.

It seems the proper punishment,
The necessary weight for balance
But am I serving justice, or feeding pride
In the elaborate religiosity of my regret?

Some nights I wonder if my guilt
Is more beloved to me than Your forgiveness
If I've made self condemnation my true religion,
Finding perverse comfort in familiar pain
Rather than the disorienting freedom of grace.
Have You been waiting all this time
For me to stop worshipping at my own shrine?

The mathematics of my guilt make perfect sense:
Sin plus remorse equals restored order.
Yet You disrupt the equation with grace
This wild, illogical erasure that leaves
No remainder, no logical conclusion.
Does my insistence on carrying what You've lifted
Suggest I trust my judgment more than Yours?

My brokenness defines me

A strange refuge in guilt.

Without these scars, who am I,

And what fills the void of shame

Perhaps that's what terrifies me most

The emptiness that forgiveness would create,

The person I'd have to become without my chains.

Sometimes I imagine You watching

My elaborate self punishment with sadness,

Waiting for me to accept the key

You've already placed it in the lock.

Is my guilt an offense rather than an offering?

Do I mock Your sacrifice by insisting

On paying a debt already settled?

The irony cuts deep as revelation

That guilt itself may be my greatest sin,

The final idol I refuse to surrender,

The last piece of control I won't relinquish.

Perhaps true repentance isn't feeling worse,
But accepting the costly gift already given
The scandalous freedom of being truly, fully loved.

If You Love Me, Why Do I Hate Myself?

Your love is an ocean I cannot fathom
Boundless, they say, deeper than the cosmos.
Yet here I stand on its shore, parched,
Unable to cup enough in my hands
To quench the desert of self hatred within.
How can Your perfect love exist alongside
The perfect contempt I've cultivated for myself?

I study my reflection in mirror shards,
Each fragment showing a different failure,
A comprehensive mosaic of inadequacy.
They tell me I bear Your image,
But all I see are the ways I've defaced it
The divine fingerprint smudged beyond recognition.
Is this distortion my vision or Your creation?

I've heard the sermons, memorized the verses:
"Fearfully and wonderfully made," they insist,
While my mind catalogs evidence to the contrary.
Did You know, when You knit me together,
That I would spend a lifetime trying to unravel
The very fabric of who You made me to be?
What kind of love allows such self destruction?

Your voice calls me beloved,
But mine whispers impostor.
Your hand offers acceptance,
But mine forms a fist against my chest.
Your eyes see beauty,
But mine fixate on flaws.
Can both realities exist in the same universe?

Sometimes I wonder if self hatred is itself
A twisted form of pride the arrogance
Of believing my judgment trumps Yours,
Of trusting my perception over divine insight.
Have I made an idol of my unworthiness,

Worshipping at the shrine of my inadequacy

Rather than accepting the love You offer?

The math doesn't add up

Your perfect love

Plus my persistent self hatred

Should not equal this fraught existence.

One of us must be wrong about who I am.

Logic says it's me, yet emotion disagrees,

Clinging to familiar self condemnation

Like a prisoner who fears his own pardon.

Perhaps self hate isn't the opposite of Your love

But the inevitable shadow it casts

In hearts too small to contain it.

Maybe my hatred isn't failure but growing pain

The necessary friction as my soul expands

To hold a love too vast for human comprehension,

The birth pangs of becoming who You see.

Am I Even Redeemable?

There must be souls beyond salvaging,
Some cosmic triage that even You perform
Hearts too black for cleansing,
Minds too twisted to straighten,
Souls too shattered for restoration.
I fear I've crossed that invisible line
Where even divine mercy must admit defeat.

I've counted my sins like stars
Until the night sky of my conscience
Holds no space for light between darkness.
The weight of them bends me toward earth,
A spiritual gravity I cannot escape.
Is there a mathematical limit to grace,
A point where the equation of redemption fails?

How many second chances can exist
Before "again" becomes mockery?
How many broken promises constitute
A heart fundamentally opposed to goodness?
I've constructed a theology of my unworthiness,

Complex arguments for my exception to grace.

Did You create certain souls knowing they're disposable?

The stories speak of You leaving ninety nine

To find the one but what if that one

Has wandered off a hundred times before?

Surely divine patience has its breaking point,

Some final straw that even You won't overlook.

I've built my identity on being irreparable

What if that's the one belief You won't contradict?

Sometimes I wonder if this fear itself

Is the final barrier to redemption

Not my sins, but my certainty they define me,

Not my failures, but my faith in their finality.

Have I made an idol of my brokenness,

Worshipping at the altar of what cannot be fixed

Rather than surrendering to what can be transformed?

The question echoes in the chambers of my heart:

If I believe myself beyond redemption,

Am I calling You impotent or unloving?
What hubris lurks in my despair
As if my sin could outreach Your grace,
As if I alone among creation
Could it prove too difficult for the Creator to restore?

Perhaps being redeemable has nothing to do
With the magnitude of darkness I contain,
But with the nature of the Light itself
Not a matter of my worthiness
But of Your relentless, resourceful love
That finds ways to use even broken things,
It specializes in making masterpieces from ruins.

How Many Times Will You Forgive Me Before You Give Up?

I've counted my returns to You like tide marks
Each one stained with shame a different shade,
Each apology worn thinner than the last,
The words fraying from overuse.

How many times can the same lips say "sorry"
Before the sound loses meaning entirely,
Before even divine ears grow deaf to repetition?

I keep a mental tally of my failures,
Notches on the bedpost of my conscience
Surely You must keep a similar account.
Is there a threshold I approach unconsciously,
Some cosmic limit to divine patience
Where even Your endless grace must acknowledge
The futility of forgiving what never truly changes?

Your disciples once asked about forgiveness
"Seven times?" they ventured, generous to a fault.
"Seventy times seven," You replied, casual
As if suggesting an afternoon stroll.
But I've done the math: four hundred ninety.
I passed that milestone years ago.
What happens at four hundred ninety one?

Sometimes I picture You with an abacus,
Celestial fingers sliding beads across eternity,
Each click marking another chance extended,
Another fresh start that I'll inevitably squander.
Does Your hand ever hesitate before resetting the count?
Does divine mercy ever consider retirement,
Worn out from my relentless consumption of grace?

The fear lives in me like a second heartbeat
That I am testing even infinite patience,
That someday I'll approach Your throne
Only to find the door finally, irrevocably locked.
Not from cruelty, but from wisdom
The recognition that some vessels are determined
To remain sieves, forever leaking what fills them.

What terrifies me most isn't Your anger
But the possibility of Your resignation
Not the thunderous voice of judgment
But the quiet sigh of giving up.
Would You release me with regret but resolution,

Like a bird that refuses to heal it's broken wing,
Like a child who will not stop playing with fire?

Yet here's the miracle that stops my breath:
Each time I return, tail tucked between my legs,
You're watching the horizon as if for the first time,
Eyes shaded against the sun, scanning for my silhouette.
Each forgiveness feels brand new, freshly minted,
As if You haven't spent eternity
Perfecting the art of welcoming me home.

Did You Ever Think About Starting Over?

Did You ever stand at the edge of creation,
Looking at the chaos You had unleashed,
And wonder if the spark was worth the fire?
Did You ever hold the blueprint of humanity
And feel the weight of what You'd made
A species destined to break itself
Before it could ever understand love?

Did You ever think about wiping the slate clean,
Erasing the stars You hung with trembling hands?
Did You imagine a world without us,
A silence where our cries never echoed,
A void where no prayers rose to meet You,
Where no one cursed Your name
For the pain You allowed to exist?

When the first murder stained the earth,
Did You hesitate, hand hovering over the reset button?
Did You see Cain's shadow stretch across time,
A lineage of blood and betrayal,
And wonder if the cost of free will
Was it too high for you to bear?
Did You regret the breath You gave us?

When the floodwaters rose,
Did You feel relief or sorrow?
Did the screams of the drowning
Reach Your ears, or Did You turn away?
Did You cry for the world You destroyed,

Or was it easier to let it go,
To pretend it was never there at all?

Did You ever think about starting over,
Not with water, but with fire this time?
Did You imagine a world without sin,
Without the weight of our endless failures?
Or did You know, even then,
That perfection would be a prison,
And love cannot exist without choice?

Did You ever think about starting over,
Or did You love us too much to let us go?
Did You see something in our brokenness
That even You couldn't explain?
Did You hope that one day,
We might surprise You,
That we might finally be worth the pain?

**Was There A Moment You Considered Wiping Us Out
Completely?**

Was there a moment, God,
When You looked at the mess we'd made
And thought, "Enough"?
When the wars piled bodies like mountains,
When the earth groaned under the weight of our greed,
When the prayers of the innocent
Were drowned out by the laughter of the wicked
Did You consider ending it all?

Did You ever stand at the edge of time,
Watching the centuries unravel like thread,
And wonder if the tapestry was worth it?
Did You see the faces of the unborn,
The ones who would suffer for sins not their own,
And feel the urge to stop the clock,
To let the universe collapse into silence?

When the Holocaust burned,
When slavery chained Your children,
When famine hollowed out entire nations,
Did You think, even for a second,

That we were beyond saving?

Did You weigh the scales of justice and mercy

And find us wanting,

Find us unworthy of the breath You gave?

Was there a moment,

In the quiet of eternity,

When You whispered to Yourself,

“This is not what I intended”?

Did You feel the ache of disappointment

In the hearts You had shaped,

The hands You had formed to create,

Now destroying everything You called good?

Did You ever consider wiping us out completely,

Not with a flood, but with a thought?

Did You imagine a world without us,

A creation that didn't rebel,

That didn't spit in the face of its Maker?

Or did You know, even then,

That love cannot exist without pain?

Was there a moment You considered giving up,
Or did You hold on,
Not because we deserved it,
But because You couldn't bear to let us go?

When You Flooded The World, Did You Cry?

When the rain began to fall,
Did You feel the weight of every drop?
Did You hear the screams of the drowning,
The pounding fists on the ark's closed door?
Did You cry, God,
As the waters rose,
As the world You had spoken into being
Was swallowed by the silence of the deep?

Did You mourn the children,
The ones who never had a chance to sin?
Did You grieve for the mothers clutching their babies,
For the fathers who couldn't save them?
Did You feel the loss of every life,

Or was it easier to focus on Noah,
To pretend the rest didn't matter?

When the animals floated lifeless,
When the trees were uprooted,
When the mountains disappeared beneath the waves,
Did You hesitate, even for a moment?
Did You wonder if the punishment
Was too great for the crime,
If the flood was justice,
Or just another mistake?

Did You cry, God,
When the last voice was silenced,
When the earth was nothing but water and regret?
Did You look at the rainbow You placed in the sky
And feel the weight of Your promise,
The vow never to destroy us again,
Even though You knew we would deserve it?

When You flooded the world,
Did You cry for what was lost,
Or did You cry for what remained?
Did You weep for the ones who perished,
Or for the ones who would carry the burden
Of rebuilding a broken world?

Did You cry, God,
Or did You turn away,
Unable to face the destruction
Of what You had once called good?

Are We A Failure Or A Lesson?

Are we Your greatest failure,
Or Your most painful lesson?
Did You create us to reflect Your glory,
Only to see us shatter the mirror?
Did You hope we would rise above,
Or did You always know
We would fall?

Are we the experiment that went wrong,
The garden that grew weeds instead of flowers?
Did You plant us in the soil of free will,
Only to watch us choke on our own choices?
Did You see the potential for beauty,
Or were we always destined
To be a cautionary tale?

Are we a failure,
A mistake You regret but cannot undo?
Or are we the lesson You needed to learn,
The reminder that even perfection
Cannot force love?
Did You create us to teach Yourself
That even a God can be surprised?

Do You look at us with disappointment,
Or with hope?
Do You see the cracks in our souls
And think, "This is not what I intended"?
Or do You see the light that still shines through,

The glimmers of goodness
That refuses to be extinguished?

Are we a failure,
Or are we the lesson
That love worth the risk?
That even in our brokenness,
Are we capable of something divine?
Do You regret making us,
Or do You hold on,
Hoping that one day,
We might finally get it right?

Do You Ever Feel Trapped By Your Own Promises?

Do You ever feel the weight of Your own words,
The chains of the promises You made?
When You swore never to flood the earth again,
Did You feel relief,
Or did You feel trapped?

Did You wonder if mercy

Would one day cost You more than justice?

Do You ever regret the covenant You made,

The rainbow You hung in the sky?

Do You look at the world we've created

And wish You could take it back,

That You could start over

Without the burden of Your own faithfulness?

When You promised Abraham descendants,

Did You foresee the wars they would fight,

The blood they would spill in Your name?

When You gave us free will,

Did You know it would lead to this

A world where Your promises

Feel like a noose around Your neck?

Do You ever feel trapped, God,

By the vows You cannot break?

Do You look at us and think,

“This is not what I wanted,
But I cannot go back?”
Do You feel the weight of Your own love,
The cost of a grace
That refuses to let go?

Do You ever wish You could undo it all,
Not because You don’t love us,
But because love has become
The heaviest burden of all?

If You Could Undo Us, Would You?

If You could go back to the beginning,
To the moment before You said, “Let there be light,”
Would You speak those words again?
Would You breathe life into the dust,
Knowing it would one day curse You?
Would You create us,
Knowing we would break Your heart?

If You could undo us,

Would You?

Would You erase the wars,

The hatred, the suffering,

The endless cycle of sin and redemption?

Would You choose silence over chaos,

Void over creation,

Peace over love?

Do You ever look at us and think,

“This was not worth it”?

Do You see the pain we cause,

The destruction we bring,

And wish You could take it all back?

Or do You hold on,

Not because we deserve it,

But because You cannot bear to let us go?

If You could undo us,

Would You choose a world without us,

A world without the weight of our failures?

Or would You choose us again,
Not because we are good,
But because we are Yours?

Or Do You Love Us Too Much To Let Go?

Do You love us, God,
Even when we are unlovable?
Do You see the mess we've made,
The pain we've caused,
And still call us Your children?
Do You hold us in Your hands,
Even when we try to slip through Your fingers?

Do You love us too much to let go,
Even when we curse Your name?
Even when we turn our backs on You,
When we choose darkness over light,
When do we break every promise we've made?
Do You still see something in us
That makes it all worth it?

Do You love us,
Not because we are good,
But because You are?
Do You hold on,
Not because we deserve it,
But because You cannot bear to lose us?

Do You love us too much to let go,
Even when we fail You,
Even when we fail ourselves?
Do You see the spark of divinity
In the ashes of our humanity?
Do You believe in us,
Even when we no longer believe in You?

Do You love us, God,
Not because of who we are,
But because of who You are?
Do You hold on,
Not because we are worthy,
But because love cannot let go?

Do I Keep Asking For Answers I Refuse To Accept?

I lay my questions down like bricks,
stacking them into walls too high to see over.

I say I want truth,
but only the kind that doesn't break me.

I beg for wisdom,
but only the kind that agrees with what I already know.

I pretend I'm waiting for Your voice,
but I only listen for the answers I like.

You whisper in winds,
but I demand a storm.

You place signs at my feet,
but I walk past them, looking for neon.

You close doors that will destroy me,
but I keep banging my fists, demanding they open.

I ask why the pain lingers,
but I won't let go of the wound.

I say I want healing,
but only if it doesn't require change.

I say I trust You,
but I still make my own plans in secret.

I say You are good,
but only when life feels easy.

I call You silent,
but maybe I've just mastered the art of selective hearing.

I demand an answer,
But what if You've already given it?

What if I buried it beneath my pride?

What if I ignored it because it asked too much of me?

What if I'm not waiting on You

What if You're waiting on me to admit I already know?

Because deep down, I do.

I always have.

And maybe that's the real reason I keep asking.

Maybe I don't want the answer.

Maybe I just want permission to keep pretending.

Am I Too Impatient For Your Timing?

I treat time like a finish line,
sprinting toward a future I haven't earned.

I tap my foot at eternity's door,
like a child throwing a tantrum.

I ask You why things take so long,
but I never question why I rush.

I want mountains to move,
but I refuse to climb.

I want the blessing,
but not the breaking that builds it.

I want the crown,
but not the cross that comes first.

I call it faith,
but it's just control wrapped in scripture.

I claim to trust You,
but I keep checking my watch.

I act like You work on my schedule,
as if You owe me a deadline.

But You don't rush seasons
just because I'm impatient.

The earth turns without my permission.
The sun rises without my consent.

So who am I to demand urgency
from a God who paints time in galaxies?

Maybe I don't need faster answers.

Maybe I need slower faith.

Maybe patience isn't punishment

Maybe it's protection.

Maybe the waiting isn't empty

Maybe it's building me in ways I don't yet understand.

Maybe I don't need to know when.

Maybe I just need to know You.

Because time has never been my enemy.

My doubt has.

Do You Stay Silent Because I Already Know The Answer?

I act like I'm lost,

but the road has always been beneath my feet.

I pretend I don't understand,

but the truth has been stitched into my bones.

I call You silent,
but maybe You're just done repeating Yourself.

Maybe You don't waste words
on lessons already carved into my soul.

Maybe You stopped answering
because I stopped listening.

Because I only hear what I want.
Because I only obey what's convenient.

You told me to let go,
but I held tighter.

You told me to move forward,
but I stood still, waiting for an easier path.

You told me to trust You,
but I demanded proof.

You told me the truth,
but I called it too hard.

You gave me direction,
but I kept looking for detours.

And now I sit in silence,
wondering why You won't speak.

But maybe You already did.

Or Are You Just Done Talking?

The silence hangs heavy, like a curtain drawn in a storm.
I whisper your name into the void, searching for a ripple.
Every unanswered prayer feels like a door closed forever.
I wonder if your voice has been lost in the echoes of my faults.
Perhaps you've tired of my constant clamor, my desperate pleas.
I trace memories of past conversations, each word a fragile relic.
Was it the arrogance of my demands that drove you away?
Or the relentless noise of my unsatisfied heart?
In the quiet, I hear the ghost of your once thundering promise.
I question if your silence is the end of love, or its transformation.
Every pause in our dialogue is a chasm of unspoken grief.
The weight of your absence bears down like dusk on broken dreams.

I search for signs in the falling leaves and distant thunder.
Maybe the stillness is not an ending, but a test of my resolve.
I recall the warmth of your words, soft as the morning dew.
Now they are memories, fading into the cold reality of emptiness.
My doubts multiply like shadows in a room with no light.
I ask if I pushed you away with my constant need for certainty.
Or if I misunderstood the quiet as your final goodbye.
In this silence, my own voice echoes back with painful honesty.
I try to decipher if your withdrawal is sorrow, pride, or despair.
The unanswered calls and silent nights ask the hardest question.
Is this absence a punishment for my stubborn disbelief?
Or is it the start of a dialogue I'm too afraid to embrace?
In the end, I stand alone, waiting for the one sign that proves you still
care.

Did I Lose You, Or Did I Just Never Know You?

In the mirror of my soul, I search for your reflection.
Was your face ever there, or am I haunted by a myth?
I built altars of hope and carved your name in every prayer.
Yet every offering fell to ashes, leaving only whispers.

I wonder if our connection was ever real or just a phantom dream.
I recall moments when I felt you near, only to be left cold.
Perhaps I mistook solitude for communion, pain for presence.
I question whether I ever truly saw you or only the longing for love.
My heart clings to memories like leaves in a furious storm.
Each recollection poses a question without an answer.
I wander through the ruins of faith, desperately searching for you.
The echoes of my doubts challenge every sign that once felt true.
I strain to hear a voice, a hint of the divine in the mundane.
But the silence roars, a testament to what might have been.
I mourn the loss of something I never fully held.
I weep for the connection that remains an unclaimed promise.
Was it a friendship, a bond, or simply a cruel illusion?
The emptiness between us forms a canyon of unanswered prayers.
I question whether I built you up or merely wished for your presence.
My soul trembles in the space where you should have been.
I face the truth: perhaps you were never meant to be known.
The quest for you mirrors the void inside me.
I surrender to the silence, accepting the unknown.

In letting go, I wonder if losing you meant losing a part of myself.

And so I stand, haunted by the possibility that I never truly knew you.

If You're Still Here, Give Me A Sign Or Have You Given Up?

The midnight sky trembles under the weight of my pleas.

I stand at the crossroads of despair and hope, heart in trembling hands.

If You are near, let the heavens shatter in gentle fury.

Let a comet blazing across the night is a burning testimony.

Speak in the rustle of leaves, in the murmurs of the ancient earth.

I beg for a whisper, a subtle cue to mend my fractured faith.

Each heartbeat echoes a silent, desperate question.

Is Your presence still a promise, or have You turned away?

I search for a sign in every falling star, every ripple in time.

My soul aches for the comfort of a divine touch.

Let the wind carry words that my eyes have longed to decipher.

Let the rain trace messages on the parched ground of my doubt.

I need a signal to shatter the oppressive quiet of my uncertainty.

Perhaps a flower will bloom in the dead of winter.

Or a tear will fall that mirrors the depth of my longing.

Every moment stretches a canvas waiting for Your art.
I stand naked before the universe, unguarded and raw.
Every fiber of my being cries out for connection.
I am desperate for the warmth of Your eternal gaze.
Is this silence a test of my perseverance or a final farewell?
My faith flickers like a candle, yearning for a spark.
I implore You to break this stillness, to offer me a sign.
Without Your whisper, I drift in a sea of uncertainty.
The silence roars with the echo of my unanswered calls.
So, if You're still here, speak now if not, let this quiet seal my fate.

Will You Abandon Me If I Stop Praying?

My prayers were lifelines cast into an endless void.
Every whispered plea was a desperate bid for connection.
I knelt in brokenness, hoping for a miracle to mend me.
Yet now I wonder if my devotion was ever enough.
What if I let go if I allow my voice to fall silent?
Would You still be there, steadfast in the quiet aftermath?
Is love measured by the cadence of our pleas?
Or does it exist as an unwavering presence beyond my doubts?

I fear that in my silence, I might lose the gentle touch of grace.
The quiet may roar louder than any prayer I've ever offered.
My soul trembles at the thought of being left alone in that void.
Every unanswered plea adds weight to my fear of abandonment.
Yet still, I cling to a hope that defies logic and reason.
Would You reach for me if I chose to fall silent?
Could Your love span the chasm left by my missing words?
I question whether my need to pray was merely a mask for despair.
If I stop, is that surrender and acceptance of isolation?
Must my faith be measured only by the sound of my pleas?
In the quiet absence of my voice, do You remain open?
I dream of a love that endures without constant affirmation.
A love as vast and unyielding as the silent stars overhead.
Even if my prayers fade into distant echoes,
I long to believe You remain steadfast, true, and eternal.
So tell me, if I stop praying, will You still hold me close?
Can love endure in the silence of a heart unvoiced?

Can I Be Atheist And Still Be Yours?

I stand at the edge of belief, questioning every sacred story.
My heart beats with rhythms that defy ancient dogma.
Scriptures echo like distant memories of a past life.
Yet a hidden part of me yearns for the divine touch.
Can love transcend the rigid boundaries of faith?
Is there room for doubt within the sanctuary of your embrace?
I wander through barren landscapes of disbelief,
Searching for a spark that defies the cold logic of reason.
Must I renounce my doubts to claim Your love?
Can I be both skeptic and beloved, rebellious and cherished?
I wear my uncertainty like armor, yet I remain achingly vulnerable.
In the silence of my questioning, I sense Your steady heartbeat.
Love should not be a transaction dictated by belief.
It ought to be an enduring promise beyond the confines of creed.
My mind questions while my soul longs for a deeper connection.
I crave a love that embraces my fractured certainty.
Must I recite ritual prayers to prove my worthiness?
I challenge the notion that unwavering belief is the only key.
Can our souls meet where reason and wonder intertwine?
Is it possible to be both the architect of doubt and the recipient of grace?

I long for a love that accepts me in my raw, unfiltered form.
Even as I question, I feel the tender pulse of Your care.
A love that murmurs softly, "I am yours," even in the void.
So tell me can I be an atheist and still call You mine?

If I Leave You, Will You Chase Me?

I stand at the precipice of abandonment, trembling with fear.
The thought of walking away haunts each uncertain step.
My heart is a restless wanderer, desperate for solace.
Yet what if I choose to leave, casting off my familiar chains?
Would You pursue me, reaching out through the dark unknown?
Or would I vanish into a shadow too elusive to capture?
My doubts scream in the cavernous silence of solitude.
I question if love is a relentless, tender pursuit.
Could Your footsteps echo behind mine in the deep night?
Would Your heart beat faster in the silence of my departure?
The possibility of loss is a weight too crushing to bear.
Still, a daring part of me craves to test the limits of grace.
Is love defined by the distance bridged in our reunion?
Or is it a bond that endures even as paths diverge?

I envision a scene where I dissolve into the horizon's edge.
And You, unwavering, chase the echoes of my fleeing soul.
My heart dares to wonder if breaking free is salvation or ruin.
Will the love we built shatter, or will it soar beyond the void?
Could the chase itself testify to the strength of our bond?
A love so fierce it defies even the silence of separation.
I ask the night: will Your love be the beacon that follows me?
A light that guides even when I stray far from home.
Or will I be left to drift, forever lost in my own leaving?
The possibility terrifies and thrills me in equal measure.
So if I leave, will You chase me, or must I wander alone?

Or Will You Just Watch Me Go?

In the hidden corners of my heart, I sense a looming farewell.
I wonder if my departure will be met with quiet resignation.
Will You, in all Your vast mystery, simply observe my retreat?
Or will Your eyes blaze with the fierce light of unyielding love?
I fear that love might sometimes reduce itself to a distant spectator.
That devotion can slip into indifference, a cold, detached witness.
In the theater of my sorrow, am I merely a solitary actor?

A fading ghost in a scene that has long lost its color?
I imagine a world where my leaving is rendered in silent film.
Each moment a still frame, void of sound or vibrant life.
Would You, in Your infinite grace, watch as I dissolve into memory?
Or would You surge forth like a storm, breaking the stillness?
The coldness of inaction is a terror too sharp to endure.
I fear that if You merely watch, I become a tragedy unredeemed.
Love should not be passive, a mere observer of my pain.
It must be the force that draws me back from the brink.
In my darkest hour, I yearn for more than just a watching eye.
I need the rescue, the touch that shatters my isolation.
Without it, I remain stranded in a void where hope withers.
I challenge this silence, pleading for a love that actively fights.
One that refuses to let me fade into the twilight.
I cry out for intervention in the face of impending loss.
So tell me, will You just watch me go, or will You fight to hold me?

If I Come Back, Will You Pretend I Never Left?

I wander through corridors of lost time, steeped in uncertainty.
Each step echoes with the heaviness of my long absence.

If I return, will You greet me as though I had never vanished?
Or will the scars of my leaving brand me as a stranger?
My heart aches with the desire to be reawakened by Your care.
To feel the warmth of a love that forgives all transgressions.
I question whether my departure carved a wound too deep to heal.
Will You erase the memory of my flight from grace?
Or will You keep it as a silent lesson, a permanent mark?
The allure of a clean slate is both soothing and terrifying.
I fear that my absence has irreversibly altered our bond.
Can love be reset, or must it forever carry the weight of regret?
I imagine coming home to arms grown cold by solitude.
Or to smiles that hide the pain of a long forgotten farewell.
The desire for redemption burns fiercely within my soul.
I long to return to a love untainted by my wanderings.
Yet I tremble at the prospect of being a ghost among you.
An echo of a self I no longer recognize.
Would You celebrate the return of the prodigal,
Or silently mark the void where I once belonged?
I wonder if forgiveness can gently erase the past,
Or if every memory lingers like a shadow in the light.

In my longing, I dare to believe in new beginnings,
A love that offers renewal without clinging to old scars.
So if I come back, will You pretend I never left,
Or will You embrace every scar as a part of our shared truth?

Will You Let Me Choose Hell?

I stand at the crossroads of faith and defiance,
fire licking at the hem of my hesitation.
The freedom to choose burns untamed, unyielding.

In the hush of self reckoning, I ask:
Can love be unconditional if it permits my ruin?
Does grace have a breaking point?

My soul is a battlefield,
caught between salvation's whisper
and the fierce gospel of self determination.
Maybe my rejection is not rebellion
but the last, desperate reach for something real.

The notion of hell is both curse and liberation.

Can Your love follow me

into the wreckage of my own making?

If I push past mercy, will You pull me back,
or honor my choice to be lost?

I test the edges of grace with every defiant step,
watching to see if the abyss blinks first.

Yet, even as I wander toward ruin,
a phantom hope lingers in my shadow.

Must devotion require surrender?

Or can love still hold me,
even when I refuse to be held?

I demand the right to be wrong.

To fall without a hand reaching to break it.

To taste the fire and decide for myself
if it is suffering or salvation in another name.

Will You let me choose hell,
and still call me beloved?

Or does love end at the threshold
of my undoing?

Epilogue

This book was never meant to offer answers. It was meant to be a conversation one sided, raw, and unfiltered. It is the voice of someone standing at the edge of faith, staring into the abyss, screaming at a God they cannot deny yet refuse to embrace. It is the mind of a deconstructing believer unraveling, condemning, pleading, and daring to judge the Almighty. It is the struggle of a soul that both hates God and aches for Him, trapped in the tension between certainty and rebellion.

I am a devout Christian. I believe in the presence of God, in His love, in His sovereignty. But I am also deeply fascinated by those who once believed and now feel abandoned. What happens when a heart that was once worshiped turns bitter? When prayers turn to accusations? When the silence of God is no longer seen as mystery but as neglect? This book is an attempt to sit in that space not to justify it, not to explain it away, but to feel it.

There is no table of contents or sections, because there is no map for this kind of journey. I wanted the reader to step directly into the chaos, to navigate this wilderness the way one truly does without a guide, without direction, without certainty. This is not a book for those seeking easy resolutions. It is for those

who have found themselves screaming at the heavens, wondering if God is listening at all.

Maybe you are here because you have felt this pain. Maybe you are here because you fear it. Or maybe, like me, you simply want to understand. Whatever brought you here, I hope you walked through these pages not just as a reader, but as a witness to the rawest parts of faith; the ones we are often too afraid to speak aloud.